

Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology



IT3060 - Human Computer Interaction

Assignment 1 – User Research Techniques

Project Title - PunkBuster

Group Number - 2025 – WE – S1 – 03

Group Name – AntiCheat Alliance

Reg.No	Name
IT23321236	Nafy F A (Leader)
IT23321618	Rathnayaka R.M.N.P.D.
IT23205642	Gunawardhana R.D.T.A.
IT23305564	Rizvi M.Z.M.

Group Member Details

	Name with Initials	Registration Number	Workload
1.	Nafy F A (Leader)	IT23321236	• Description • Interfaces assigned ○ Press Release News Page ○ License Page ○ Careers/Join Us Page • Identified Usability issues • Scripts for users • User Interviews
2.	Rathnayaka R.M.N.P.D.	IT23321618	• Interfaces assigned ○ Support + Contact Page ○ About Us Page ○ Community Forum Page • Identified Usability issues. • Scripts for users
3.	Gunawardhana R.D.T.A.	IT23205642	• Interfaces assigned ○ Login Page ○ Sign In Page ○ Home Page • Identified Usability issues. • Scripts for users
4.	Rizvi M.Z.M.	IT23305564	• 3 Personas • Interfaces assigned ○ Games Page ○ PB Step Page ○ F&Q Page • Identified Usability issues. • Script for users

Project Description

Human Computer Interaction (HCI) is the study and practice of how humans engage with technology. It focuses on designing, testing, and developing interactive computer systems that people can use effectively, enjoyably, and safely. At its core, HCI aims to create software and technologies that bridge the gap between humans and machines, fostering smooth, intuitive, and meaningful interactions. This involves understanding user needs, behaviors, and limitations, translating those insights into design solutions that are not only functional but also engaging.

For this project, we will apply HCI principles to enhance the **PunkBuster Anti-Cheat Website** and overall user experience. PunkBuster plays a critical role in online gaming security, detecting and preventing cheating to maintain fairness and integrity in a competitive environment. However, like many technical tools, its current interface can be complex, intimidating, or confusing – particularly for first-time users or non-technical players.

Our goal is to enhance the user experience, making it easier for customers to access, set up, and manage for the players and administrators. By addressing existing usability issues, we aim to create a more user-friendly platform that effectively supports cheat prevention while reducing frustration and complexity.

Alternatives considered

Several alternative options were explored before finalizing our best choice. Each of the five members independently examined different websites for potential usability issues. The sites reviewed included:

[Penny Juice of America | Juice Concentrates | Davenport, IA](#)

[HOME | Riverside Art Center](#)

[siphawaii.com/lander](#)

[pnwx.com - Pacific Northwest X-Ray Inc.](#)

[Woodfield Building – Construction Specialists – Cannock, Staffordshire](#)

[Home - Yale School of Art](#)

Some of these sites had smooth performance and good responsiveness, with a few minor issues along the way. After careful comparison, we finally decided to go ahead with our assignment based on [Even Balance, Inc. - PunkBuster Online Countermeasures](#).

User groups identified

- Gamers – End users, install PunkBuster on their device to prevent cheating.
- Game Developer – Integrate PunkBuster into their games.
- Game Publisher Representative – Access the press release/news updates about PunkBuster.
- Administrator – Full control over the site content.
- Community Moderators – Manage forum discussions, approve posts, and remove inappropriate content
- Technical Support – Assist gamers, developers, and admins in solving PunkBuster-related issues.
- Job Applicants – Occasional user, visits careers /Join Us section to apply for jobs and internships.

Personas

Persona 01 – Gamer

GAMER **SHAZNI AZMATH**



Gender : Male
Age : 23 Y
Education : Bachelor's Degree in IT
Role : ESport Gamer
Address : 84 - Wattala, Sri Lanka

BIOGRAPHY

As lead developer at an indie studio creating a multiplayer shooter. She's evaluating PunkBuster for integration but needs clear documentation and cost transparency to convince her team.

MOTIVATIONS

Streamline PB updates for players
Justify licensing costs to stakeholders
Minimize cheating in her games

GOALS

Access clear licensing/pricing details
Test PB compatibility during development
Find technical case studies from similar games

FRUSTRATIONS

Unclear Setup Instructions
No Cheat Reporting Portal
Outdated Game List
Poor Error Handling

PERSONALITY

- Detail-oriented
- Budget-conscious
- Prefers self-service resources

TECHNOLOGY

Primary Device:

Macbook Pro

Secondary Device:

Windows Workstation

Frequently Visits:

GitHub, Stack Overflow, Unreal

BRANDS



Persona 02 – Game Developer

GAME DEVELOPER SUMAYYA



Gender : Female
Age : 22 Y
Education : Bachelor's Degree in Game Development
Role : Game Studio Developer
Address : 124- Colombo, Sri Lanka

BIOGRAPHY

As a competitive FPS gamer who plays titles like Call of Duty and Battlefield daily, He relies on PunkBuster to ensure fair play and hates encountering cheaters. While tech-savvy, he gets frustrated with complicated setups and prefers intuitive, quick solutions.

MOTIVATIONS

Play games without cheaters
Quick resolution of PB errors
Clear communication about bans

GOALS

Easily download PB for supported games
Report suspicious players efficiently
Understand why certain actions trigger bans

FRUSTRATIONS

- Outdated or unclear FAQ sections
- Clunky downloading process
- No visibility into report status
- Inconsistent PB behavior across games

PERSONALITY

- Competitive but fair
- Impatient with poor UX
- Active in gaming communities
- Trusts transparent systems

TECHNOLOGY

Primary Device: Gaming PC
Secondary Device: Mobile Phone
Frequently Visits: Steam, Twitch, Reddit

BRANDS



Persona 03 – Game Publisher Representative

GAME PUBLISHER REPRESENTATIVE HASANDI



Gender : Female
Age : 23 Y
Education : Master's in Computer Science
Role : Administrator
Address : 2A/C - Kadawatha, Sri Lanka

BIOGRAPHY

As a publisher, anti-cheat integrations for a mid-sized publisher with 15+ live multiplayer titles. She negotiates PunkBuster contracts, coordinates patch rollouts, and acts as the bridge between EvenBalance and her studio's dev/legal teams.

MOTIVATIONS

Maintain player trust through transparent cheat enforcement
Minimize downtime during PB updates
Justify PB's cost to executive leadership

GOALS

Centralized dashboard for PB's performance across all titles
Automated alerts for required game patches
Standardized SLAs for critical bug responses

FRUSTRATIONS

- Version chaos
- Legal jargon
- Black-box reporting
- Silent changes

PERSONALITY

- Balances legal, technical, and player-experience needs
- Demands hard data on PB's effectiveness
- Pushes for long-term anti-cheat roadmaps

TECHNOLOGY

Primary Device: MacBook Pro
Secondary Device: iPad Pro
Frequently Visits: AWS Service Health Dashboard, GamesIndustry.biz

BRANDS



Usability issues identified by the students

1. Navigation: Is the main menu visible and easy to access? Are menu items labeled in a way that makes sense to new users? Is there a quick way to jump to important sections like “Download” or “Support”?
2. Layout: Is the layout clean and logically organized? Does the design avoid visual clutter? Is there a clear flow directing users toward key functions?
3. Search Functionality: Is there a search bar to help users quickly find troubleshooting guides, FAQs, or downloads? Is it positioned where users expect it?
4. Mobile Responsiveness: Does the site work well on smartphones and tablets? Is the content easy to read and interact with on small screens without excessive zooming or scrolling?
5. Readability: Are the fonts large enough and easy to read? Is there adequate contrast between text and background? Is the spacing between paragraphs comfortable?
6. Call to Action: Are important action buttons (e.g., “Download Now,” “Get Support”) prominent and clearly labeled so users understand what will happen when clicked?
7. Loading Speed: Does the site load quickly, even for users with slower internet connections? Are large files or images slowing the page down?
8. Consistency: Are fonts, colors, and visual styles consistent across all pages? Do interface elements behave the same way in every section?
9. Error Handling: When something goes wrong (e.g., failed download, missing page), are clear and helpful error messages shown? Are users guided on how to fix the issue?
10. Forms: Are registration or feedback forms simple to complete? Are only essential fields included? Is there real-time validation to prevent errors before submission?
11. Images and Media: Are all images optimized for fast loading without losing quality? If videos are used, do they have basic controls like play, pause, and volume?
12. Pop-ups and Ads: Are pop-ups limited to essential notifications? Are there any intrusive banners or third-party ads that disrupt the browsing experience?
13. Accessibility: Does the site provide alt text for images? Is it compatible with screen readers? Does it meet WCAG standards for color contrast and keyboard navigation?
14. Download Process: Is the process of downloading PunkBuster straightforward, with clear steps and visible progress indicators? Are the installation instructions easy to follow?
15. Support & Help Access: Is the support section easy to locate? Are FAQs, troubleshooting guides, and contact options clear and well-structured for different types of users?

Scripts

User 01

Background description of the user – Game

Shazni Azmath, 23, is a highly dedicated E-Sports gamer with a strong passion for competitive multiplayer FPS games. He spends countless hours refining his skills, mastering game mechanics, and analyzing strategies to stay ahead in a tournament. With a sharp understanding of player psychology and teamwork, Shazni consistently adapts to challenges and thrives under competitive pressure. Fair play and integrity are central to his approach, as he values balanced gameplay and relies on anti-cheat solutions like PunkBuster to maintain competition standards.

Questions to be asked from the user

- Did you previously use this website? How long have you been integrating PunkBuster into your games? (Face expression: – Neutral, Professional)
- Are you currently maintaining any games with PunkBuster enabled? (Face expression: – Neutral)
- Do you find PunkBuster’s documentation and gamer resources comprehensive?
(Face expression: – Sad)
- What do u think about the download/updates of PunkBuster? (Face expression: – Neutral)
- Have you ever been in contact with the game’s support team regarding PunkBuster issues? (Face expression: – Glare)
- What is your idea about the PunkBuster License Inquiry? (Face expression: - Distant stare)
- What do you think of the entire layout? (Face expression: – Distant stare)
- Are you completely satisfied with the website? (Face expression: - Bored)
- Do you have any recommendations about how to enhance the website?
(Face expression: – Thoughtful, Strategic)

Task to be given to the user

- Visit the homepage
- Search information about the games currently supported by Punkbuster.
- Navigate to the About page
- Navigate to the F&Q for Game
- Locate the Punkbuster License Inquiry
- Locate the downloads
- Navigate to the Support and Contact Team

User 02

Background description of the user – Game Developer

Sumayya, 22, is a skilled game developer who dedicates significant time to creating engaging, competitive multiplayer FPS games. With a deep understanding of game mechanics, network performance, and player psychology, they aim to ensure a fair, enjoyable gaming experience for all users. They often work closely with anti-cheat solutions such as PunkBuster to maintain integrity in their games. Technical precision and efficiency are their top priorities, and they constantly monitor, test, and improve features to eliminate exploits and cheating.

Questions to be asked from the user

- Did you previously use this website? How long have you been integrating PunkBuster into your games? (Face expression: – Neutral, Professional)
- Are you currently maintaining any games with PunkBuster enabled? (Face expression: – Relieved))
- Do you find PunkBuster’s documentation and developer resources comprehensive? (Face expression: – Neutral)
- What is your idea about the PunkBuster License Inquiry? (Face expression: - Distant stare)
- Did u find any F&Q section for Game Developers? If yes, what is your idea about the page? (Face expression: – Glare)
- Were you able to find the About Us page on this website? (Face expression: – Neutral)
- Have you ever been in contact with the game’s support team regarding PunkBuster issues? (Face expression: – Glare)
- What do you think of the entire layout? (Face expression: – Distant stare)
- Are you completely satisfied with the website? (Face expression: - Bored)
- Are there any PunkBuster features you wish to see improved or added? (Face expression: – Thoughtful, Strategic)

Task to be given to the user

- Visit the homepage
- Search information about the games currently supported by Punkbuster.
- Navigate to the About page
- Navigate to the F&Q for Game Developer
- Locate the Punkbuster License Inquiry
- Locate the downloads
- Navigate to the Support and Contact Team

User 03

Background description of the user – Game Publisher Representative

Hasandi, 22, is a game publisher representative who dedicates her career to ensuring the games her company releases remain fair, secure, and trusted by players. With a strong understanding of game integrity, player trust, and industry compliance standards, she closely monitors anti-cheat systems and updates to maintain her company's reputation. Hasandi frequently reviews press releases, technical documentation, and partnership resources to make informed decisions and support her development teams. Accuracy, reliability, and timely access to official information are her top priorities, and she seeks insight that helps prevent exploits and maintain a positive player experience.

Questions to be asked from the user

- Do you regularly visit this website for official updates or press releases? (Face expression: – Professional interest)
- Is it easy to locate press releases and company announcements? (Face expression: – Focused)
- Are the press release details enough to make informal decisions about your game? (Face expression: – Analytical)
- Have you ever been in contact with the support team regarding PunkBuster any issues? (Face expression: – Glare)
- What is your idea about the PunkBuster License Inquiry? (Face expression: - Distant stare)
- What do you think of the entire layout? (Face expression: – Distant stare)
- Is it easy to navigate through the website to find the relevant sections for your specific needs? (Face expression: – Distant stare)
- Are you completely satisfied with the website? (Face expression: - Bored)
- Do you have any recommendations about how to enhance the website? (Face expression: – Thoughtful, Strategic)

Task to be given to the user

- Visit the homepage
- Locate the latest press release regarding an anti-cheat update.
- Navigate to the About page
- Navigate to the F&Q
- Locate the Punkbuster partnership License Inquiry
- Navigate to the Support and Contact Team

Ratings of the Usability problems as high, medium, and low

User 01

Issue	Reason for Identified Problem	Severity	Justification
Cluttered & outdated homepage layout	The homepage design lacks a clear visual hierarchy, making it hard for a beginner to find download links or instructions.	High	New users may feel lost immediately, causing frustration and possible abandonment of the site.
Navigation menus unclear & limited options	Menu labels are vague, and there are no dropdowns for guidance.	High	No clear navigation; poor labeling hinders them from finding important pages like "How to Install."
Language clarity issues	The site uses technical jargon without explanation.	Medium	Beginners may misunderstand security terms or installation steps, leading to mistakes.
No Search Function or Difficult to Find	The search bar is missing or hidden.	High	Beginners may not know where to look for help and will struggle without a quick search option.
Documentation and gamer resources are incomplete	User finds it incomplete or hard to use.	High	Critical of users relying on guidance, which affects usability and task completion.
The support team contact is difficult to access	Users are frustrated with the response accessibility	High	Users cannot get timely help for issues, impacting user satisfaction.
PunkBuster License inquiry is unclear	Process and location are confusing	High	Important features not easily found may prevent legitimate licensing actions.
FAQ for games is difficult to locate	Content is incomplete or hidden	High	Users cannot easily resolve common issues leading to support requests.
download instructions are unclear	Steps for download/update are not explained	Medium	This can lead to errors or frustration during installation.

User 02

Issue	Reason for Identified Problem	Severity	Justification
Difficulty finding information about supported games	The list of games currently supported by PunkBuster is hidden or not easily accessible from the homepage.	High	Developers need quick access to supported games to decide integration feasibility. Poor visibility wastes time and discourages use.
Missing or incomplete FAQ section for Game Developers	The FAQ page is either not present, too generic, or lacks game developer-specific content	High	Developers require dedicated resources; without them, they face confusion and may resort to unreliable external sources.
Cluttered & Outdated Homepage Layout	The homepage design lacks a clear visual hierarchy, making it hard for a beginner to find download links or instructions.	High	New users may feel lost immediately, causing frustration and possible abandonment of the site.
Navigation Menu Unclear & Limited Options	Content is scattered and lacks a logical flow, forcing users to hunt for critical pages, and there are no dropdowns for guidance.	High	Increases frustration and reduces trust in PunkBuster's professionalism. Affects adoption rates.
Language Clarity Issues	The site uses technical jargon without explanation.	Medium	Beginners may misunderstand security terms or installation steps, leading to mistakes.
No Search Function or Difficult to Find	The search bar is missing or hidden.	High	Beginners may not know where to look for help and will struggle without a quick search option.
No clear roadmap or feature improvement updates	Developers cannot find information on future PunkBuster updates or improvements.	Medium	Without transparency, developers may hesitate to invest in long-term use.
Support & Contact Team page not prominent	No clear "Contact" or "Support" link, or responses are slow/unreliable.	High	Developers expect fast support for anti-cheat integration. Lack of accessible support

User 03

Issue	Reason for Identified Problem	Severity	Justification
Difficulty locating official press releases and announcements	Press release updates are not centralized or clearly highlighted on the homepage	High	press releases for decision-making. Missing or buried information directly affects trust and efficiency.
Limited details in press releases	Press releases often lack technical depth or decision-making context.	Medium	While announcements exist, they don't always provide sufficient insight. Zainab must cross-check with other resources, slowing her workflow
Navigation challenges across About, FAQ, and License Inquiry	Menu labels are vague, and relevant sections are hidden under unclear paths	High	Frequent navigation delays cause frustration, especially when accessing compliance-related content (e.g., License Inquiry).
No Search Function or Difficult to Find	The search bar is missing or hidden.	High	Beginners may not know where to look for help and will struggle without a quick search option.
Lack of personalized or role-specific resources	he site doesn't provide tailored sections for publishers/press representatives.	Low	This is an enhancement opportunity rather than a major blocker, but addressing it would boost usability
Outdated or cluttered layout	Homepage and navigation design, making it hard to prioritize critical updates.	Medium	While not completely blocking, the outdated structure reduces efficiency and increases effort.

Video link for contextual inquiry for 3 users

Gamer – [Gamer.mp4 - Google Drive](#)

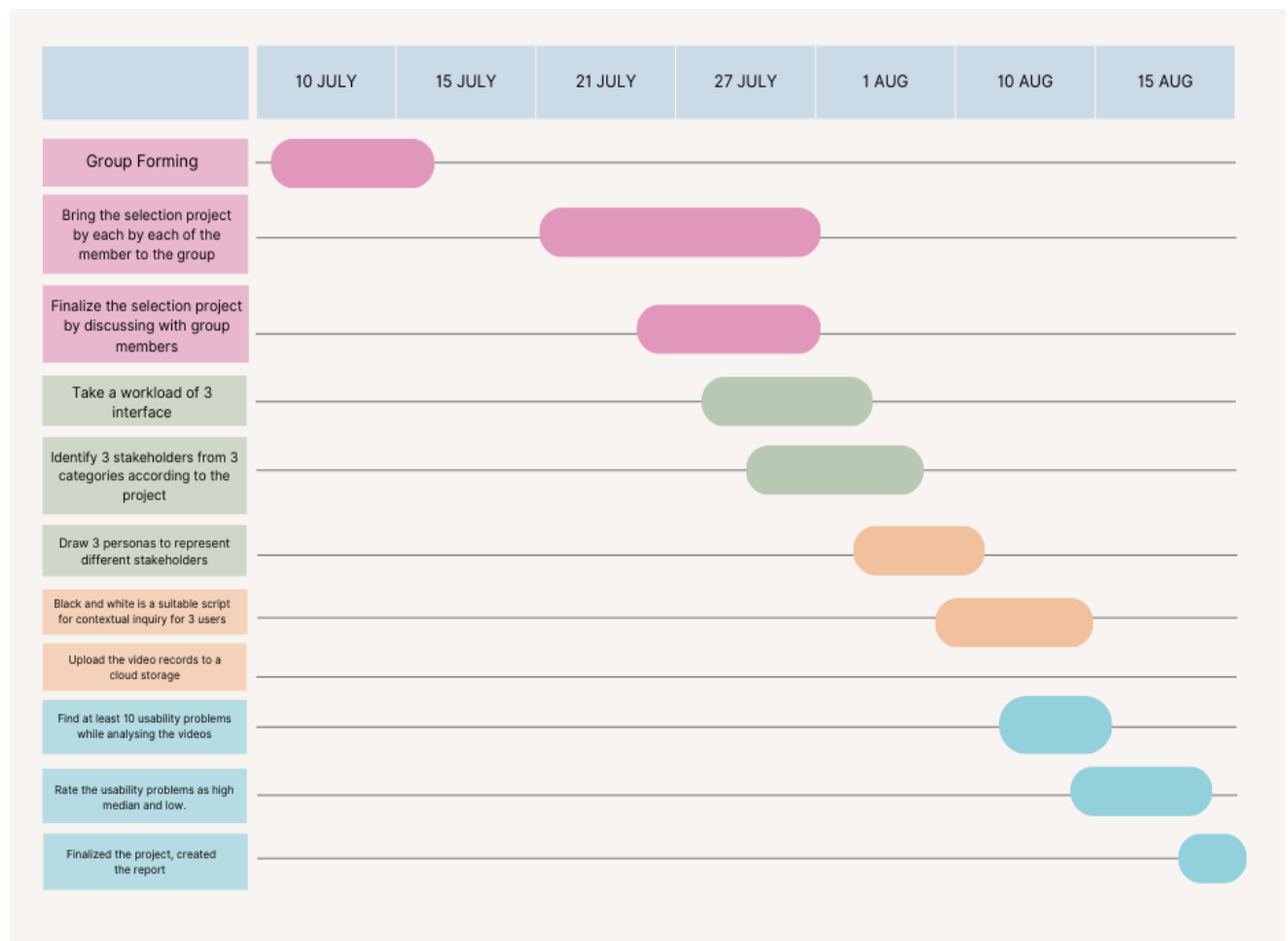
Game Developer - [Game Developer.mp4 - Google Drive](#)

Game Publisher Representative - [Game Publisher Representative.mp4 - Google Drive](#)

Suggestions identified to increase the usability based on contextual inquiry.

Issue	Mitigation Suggestions (Based on Contextual Inquiry)
Cluttered & outdated homepage layout	Redesign homepage with a clean, modern UI. Use visual hierarchy (clear headings, icons, and call-to-action buttons). Add a dedicated 'Get Started' section for beginners with prominent download links.
Navigation menus unclear & limited options	Revamp menu with descriptive labels (e.g., 'Downloads,' 'Installation Guide,' 'Support'). Introduce dropdowns or a mega-menu for easy access to key pages. Highlight the 'How to Install' link directly.
Language clarity issues	Replace with beginner-friendly language. Add tooltips or glossary popups for technical terms. Provide 'Beginner' vs. 'Advanced' documentation sections.
No Search Function or Difficult to Find	Add a visible, persistent search bar at the top-right of every page. Ensure it supports keyword suggestions (e.g., typing 'install' shows related guides).
Documentation and gamer resources are incomplete	Expand documentation with step-by-step tutorials, screenshots, and video guides. Include troubleshooting FAQs and sample configurations for popular games. Encourage community-driven guides for additional coverage.
The support team contact is difficult to access	Place a clear 'Contact Support' button on the homepage and help pages. Offer multiple channels (chatbot, email, ticket system). Add response-time expectations to reassure users.
PunkBuster License inquiry is unclear	Provide a dedicated 'Licensing' page with a simple step-by-step guide. Use clear visuals (flowcharts or FAQs). Add a contact form specifically for license-related inquiries.
FAQ for games is difficult to locate	Create a centralized, searchable FAQ hub categorized by game. Link FAQs from related pages (installation, troubleshooting). Ensure FAQs are always visible in the support menu.
The download instructions are unclear	Develop a clear 'Download & Install' wizard with numbered steps, visuals, and platform-specific guides (Windows/Mac). Include a short video walkthrough and a 'Common Mistakes' section.

Gantt chart



References

[Write a Project Description with Examples | Smartsheet](#)

[UX Research Methodologies: The Complete Guide](#)

[UX Research Cheat Sheet - NN/g](#)

[6 Steps to Identifying Usability Problems – MeasuringU](#)

Interfaces

Homepage



[Home](#) | [Games](#) | [PB Setup](#) | [FAQ](#) | [Support](#) | [Downloads](#) | [Contact](#) | [License](#)

Welcome to Even Balance, Inc., home of PunkBuster™, the original anti-cheat system. Since September of 2000, the staff members at Even Balance have worked to identify and remove cheaters from dozens of on-line games. Our approach, technology, and experience have made PunkBuster the top-tier anti-cheat solution in the video game industry.

PunkBuster proudly features:

- Decades of experience in the anti-cheat business
- Support for all major and many proprietary game engines
- Game specific cheat research and detection
- Real-time, continuous memory scanning during gameplay
- Environment modification detection
- Background auto-updates
- Administrative tools (screen shots, ban lists, streaming)

If cheating is a problem in your game, you need PunkBuster. [Read more...](#)

Fri Jan 16 2015 12:00



Electronic Arts Inc. has contracted with Even Balance, Inc. to integrate PunkBuster™ Anti-Cheat software into Battlefield Hardline™. We will soon be opening a section on our website to support PunkBuster™ for Battlefield Hardline. EA, Battlefield Hardline and the Battlefield Hardline logo are trademarks of Electronic Arts Inc. All other trademarks are the property of their respective owners.

Fri Apr 04 2014 12:00



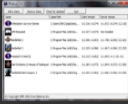
IAH Games has contracted with Even Balance, Inc. to integrate our PunkBuster™ Anti-Cheat software into the free to play online first person shooter title known as "Blacklight: Retribution" for the Southeast Asia region.

Tue Nov 19 2013 12:00



Ubisoft has contracted with Even Balance, Inc. to integrate our PunkBuster™ Anti-Cheat software into the online game known as Assassin's Creed® 4 Black Flag.

PB Setup



PB News

Mon Dec 15 2015 0:30
We have confirmed that Violation #74006 may be triggered by non-cheat software.

Wed Jun 24 2015 14:15
Version 2.352 of the PB Client for BF3 has been released to our PB Master Servers for auto-update and to our website download page.

Wed Jun 10 2015 11:00
We have confirmed that long standing Violation #51040 may be triggered by newly released non-cheat software.

Tue Apr 14 2015 14:00
We have confirmed that Violation #79623 may be triggered by non-cheat software.

Tue Apr 14 2015 14:00
We have confirmed that Violation #79623 may be triggered by non-cheat software.

Tue Apr 14 2015 9:00



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Games



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PunkBuster Supported Games	Server	Client
 America's Army Proving Grounds	v1.905	v2.341 A1376
 Battlefield 3	v1.905	v2.352 A1386
 Battlefield 4	v1.905	v2.351 A1390
 Battlefield Hardline	v1.905	v2.340 A1383
 Far Cry 3	v1.905	v2.312 A1383
 Ghost Recon Future Soldier	v1.905	v2.278 A1384
 Red Orchestra 2: Heroes of Stalingrad	v1.905	v2.313 A1372

*** Security Notices for All Games ***

News and Release Notes for PunkBuster Supported Games.



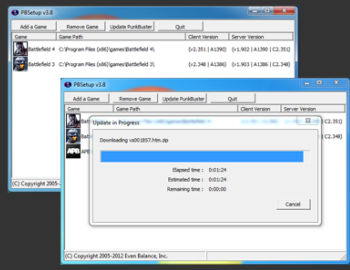
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PB Setup



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PunkBuster is designed to keep itself up to date using our proprietary auto-update system. For cases where the auto-update fails, we have created a utility named PBSetup that can manually update one or more installations of PunkBuster.

To use PBSetup:

- Download the appropriate version of PBSetup below
- Run PBSetup
- Click "Add a Game"
- Choose the game you wish to update and confirm the installation path
- Click "Update PunkBuster" to update the installations

Operating System	Version	Download
Windows	3.8	For All Windows Games
Linux	3.2	For 32-bit Linux Games (GUI version)
Linux	3.2	For 32-bit Linux Games (Command-line only version)
Linux	3.2	For 64-bit Linux Games (GUI version)
Linux	3.2	For 64-bit Linux Games (Command-line only version)
Mac OSX	3.2	For All Intel Mac OSX Games

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FAQ



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- [For Players](#)
- [For Admins](#)
- [For Game Developers/Publishers](#)

Player Frequently Asked Questions

- Installation
 - [How do I install PunkBuster?](#)
 - [How do I un-install PunkBuster?](#)
 - [How do I get PunkBuster for a game that does not currently have it?](#)
- Kick Messages
 - [I'm getting kicked from servers with a PunkBuster message. What should I do now?](#)
 - [I'm getting kicked from Battlefield 3/4/Hardline, but I can't read the kick message. How can I find the reason?](#)
- General
 - [What is a PunkBuster GUID?](#)

How do I install PunkBuster?

The PunkBuster client software is installed when you install your game. If you chose not to install PunkBuster at the time the game was installed or if you would like to reinstall PunkBuster, please download our [PBSetup utility](#) and follow the instructions.

How do I un-install PunkBuster?

If you'd like to uninstall PunkBuster, simply locate the "pb" folder under the game install folder and delete it. Note however that for some games, PunkBuster is a requirement. Un-installing PunkBuster for these games will prevent you from playing them.

How do I get PunkBuster for a game that does not currently have it?

The PunkBuster anti-cheat system is directly integrated into a game's engine. For this reason, Even Balance, Inc. works directly with a game's publisher/developer to integrate PunkBuster. There is no way to run PunkBuster in a game without tightly integrating it into the engine.

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Support



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PunkBuster Support

Trouble Ticket Support

If you are having problems with PunkBuster software, please use our web-based trouble ticket help system.

[Submit a trouble ticket](#)

Cheat Reporting

If you would like to submit information about a cheat or suspicious game activity, please e-mail:

research@evenbalance.com

PunkBuster Manuals

To learn more about the detailed features of PunkBuster, please refer to our [player and admin manuals](#).

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Downloads



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Downloads

PunkBuster Setup (PBSetup)

Normally PunkBuster keeps itself updated while you play your favorite game. If, however, you would like to manually update your PunkBuster installations, please [download our PBSetup utility](#) and follow the instructions.

PunkBuster Service Installer (pbsvc)

PunkBuster on the Windows™ operating system requires two running services. (PnkBstrA and PnkBstrB) Normally these are installed when the game is installed. If you'd like to manually install PnkBstrA and PnkBstrB, please [download our PunkBuster service installer](#).

PunkBuster UDP Console (pbucon)

PBUCON is a PunkBuster Server facility that allows server admins to obtain a remote UDP based console with a running PunkBuster Server version 1.225 or higher. Admins can use PBUCON to stream PB logging and optionally issue remote commands and optionally (for some games) stream normal game server logging. PBUCON allows concurrent real-time streaming of PB logging to multiple remote hosts and also does not require any special firewall configuration as it uses the same socket and port used by the running PunkBuster server for communication.

For a complete description of the pbucon feature, please see our [PunkBuster UDP Console manual](#).

The pbucon utility can be downloaded below:

- [Windows pbucon utility \(version 0.983\)](#)
- [Linux pbucon utility \(version 0.983\)](#)

PunkBuster MD5Tool (md5tool)

Starting in January of 2004, PunkBuster Server Admins have the option of using the new PB MD5Tool facility to check the digital signatures of files and/or portions of files in each player's game directory and child sub-directories during game play. The MD5 (Message Digest 5) algorithm was developed by Rivest and is ©Copyright by [RSA Data Security, Inc.](#). PunkBuster extensions to MD5 are ©Copyright by Even Balance, Inc. Source code for MD5 with PunkBuster extensions can be found on this page below.

For a complete description of the MD5 tool, please see our [PunkBuster MD5 manual](#).

The MD5 tool can be downloaded below:

- [Windows MD5 tool \(version 0.90\)](#)
- [Linux MD5 tool \(version 0.90\)](#)

MD5 Source Code

PunkBuster uses a modified version of the MD5 algorithm from "[RSA Data Security, Inc.](#)" A copy of the modified source code and our md5 command-line tool can be downloaded below:

- [Source code \(pbmd5.cpp\)](#)
- [Windows MD5 command-line tool](#)
- [Linux MD5 command-line tool](#)

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By Mail

Even Balance, Inc.
814 San Jacinto Blvd Suite 303
Austin, Texas 78701

Business/License Inquiries

If you are a game developer or publisher and would like information about integrating PunkBuster™ into your online game, please fill out our license inquiry form:
<http://www.evenbalance.com/license.php>

Research/Cheat Submission

If you would like to notify us of a cheat, suspicious activity, or other cheat related information for one of the games we currently support, please contact us here:
research@evenbalance.com

For technical support issues, please use our [Web Ticket System](#).

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PunkBuster License Inquiry

Thank you for your interest in licensing the PunkBuster anti-cheat system for your game. In order to provide you with accurate pricing information, please fill out and submit the following form:

****NOTE: All fields are required.**

Your Name:	
Contact e-mail:	
Confirm e-mail:	
Name of game developer:	
Location of game developer (Country, City):	
Developer web-site:	
Name of game publisher:	
Location of game publisher (Country, City):	
Publisher web-site:	
What is the current state of your game?:	No
Is your game free-to-play?:	No
What is your approximate peak CCU (player) count?:	
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